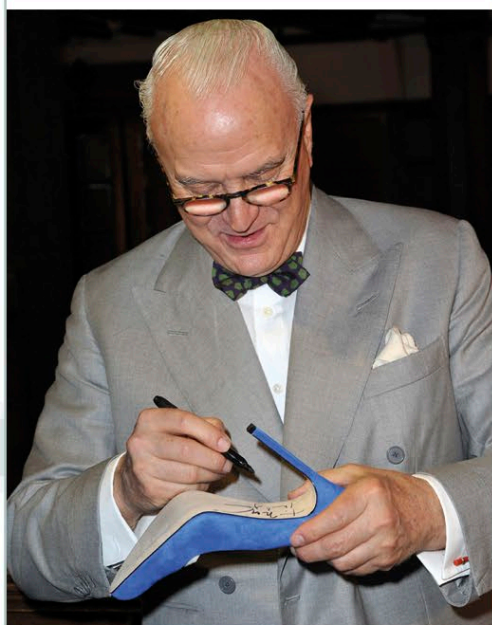


2000 ONWARDS

STATEMENT DRESSING

The point of stepping on to the red carpet has always been to make a fashion statement. But these days it is also seen as a stage for making personal statements – about sexuality, about equal rights, about not conforming – and it does not have to be on a red carpet: any big event with paparazzi in attendance will do. Rebellion on the red carpet dates back decades. In 1986, after Oscars organizers urged female guests to stop wearing pantsuits, Cher turned up in a midriff-baring, bondage-style jumpsuit. Fast-forward to 2018 when Kristen Stewart took off her high heels and walked barefoot on the red carpet in protest at the Cannes Film Festival rule that women should not wear flats. The same year, hundreds of celebrities at the Golden Globes wore black to support the Time's Up movement against sexual harassment.

SHOW-STOPPING SHOES



Manolo Blahnik

In the early days of Hollywood, the stars turned to Salvatore Ferragamo, Charles Jourdan, André Perugia, and Beth Levine for fantastic red-carpet footwear. In the 1990s a new generation took over. Credited for show-stopping heels are cult labels Christian Louboutin, Manolo Blahnik, and Jimmy Choo. Now designers Nicholas Kirkwood and Sophia Webster are creating chic shoes too.



2000

Wrapped like a beach sarong

Sheer silk skirt with colourful bamboo print

Plunging swimsuit bodice

Long train adds a formal touch

Tropical vibe Jennifer Lopez wore Versace to the 2000 Grammy Awards, reflecting the growing importance of designers' resort collections. Her dress prompted so many internet searches that Google decided to develop its image-search feature.



2001

3D swan head around neck

Nude bodystocking underneath

Layered tulle ballerina skirt

Funfair fashion Bjork rejected any ideas of looking elegant in this tutu – a joking reference to animals on a merry-go-round. Despite topping the worst-dressed lists for the 2001 Oscars, the dress by Marjan Pejoski became iconic.

2013

V-detail gives glimpse of cleavage

Peplum waist emphasizes narrow skirt

Long, sweeping train



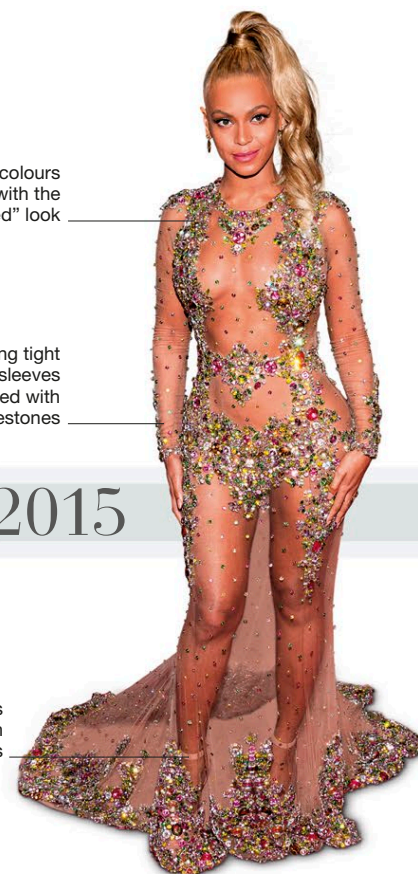
Brand ambassador As the advertising face of Christian Dior, Charlize Theron of course wore the label to the 2013 Oscars. The simplicity of her white two-piece couture gown, combined with her pixie haircut, projected modern femininity and reflected the brand values of Dior.

2015

Sweet floral colours contrast with the "undressed" look

Long tight sleeves dotted with rhinestones

Nude shoes blend with the dress



Pretty naked Appearing to wear only strategically placed flowers, Beyoncé stole the limelight at the 2015 Met Gala. A sketch of the dress by Givenchy Haute Couture, posted on Twitter beforehand, built anticipation.